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System for target arcing mapping and plasma diagnosis

Abstract

Methods of monitoring arcing in a process chamber, processing chambers and monitoring apparatus are described. At least one of the angular or radial position of a magnetron is determined in the chamber relative to a reference location on a surface of the substrate using positional information from one or more motors. An arcing profile is generated comprising a plurality of arcing states measured based at least on the determined angular and/or radial position of the magnetron.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the disclosure are directed to apparatus and methods for mapping target arcing. In particular, embodiments of the disclosure are directed to apparatus and methods for mapping target arcing in physical vapor deposition (PVD) processing chambers.

BACKGROUND

(2) Reliably producing submicron and smaller features is one of the challenges for the next generation of very large-scale integration (VLSI) and ultra large scale integration (ULSI) of semiconductor devices. However, as the miniaturization of circuit technology continues, the shrinking dimensions of interconnects in VLSI and ULSI technology have placed additional demands on the processing capabilities. For example, as circuit densities increase for next generation devices, the widths of interconnects, such as vias, trenches, contacts, gate structures and other features, as well as the dielectric materials therebetween, decrease while the thickness of the dielectric layers remains substantially constant, with the result of increasing the aspect ratios of the features.

(3) Sputtering, also known in one application as physical vapor deposition (PVD), is a method of forming metallic features in integrated circuits. In such applications, sputtering deposits a material layer on a substrate. A source material, such as a target, is bombarded by ions strongly accelerated by an electric field. The bombardment ejects material from the target, and the material then deposits on the substrate. In other applications, however, sputtering may also be used to etch a

substrate.

(4) During deposition and etching using a magnetron assembly, arcing from the target to the substrate or chamber components can occur. Arcing can result in substrate damage and film deposition non-uniformity. In addition, other factors, such as process conditions or process chamber design, can also undesirably affect processing uniformity on the substrate. Determining the source of arcing can be difficult as the location within the chamber of any particular arc is not known. Troubleshooting and repair requires opening the process chamber which can be a time-consuming and expensive process.

(5) Accordingly, there is a need in the art for apparatus and methods to measure arc locations within a process chamber.

SUMMARY

(6) One or more embodiments of the disclosure are directed to a method of monitoring arcing in a process chamber. The method includes: determining at least an angular position of a magnetron in the process chamber relative to a reference location on a surface of the substrate using positional information of a motor used to position the magnetron; and generating an arcing profile including a plurality of arcing states measured based at least on the determined angular position of the magnetron.

(7) Additional embodiments of the disclosure are directed to an apparatus for monitoring arcing within a process chamber including a moveable magnetron and at least one power supply. The apparatus includes: a processor; and a memory coupled to the processor. The memory has stored therein instructions executable by the processor to configure the apparatus to: determine at least an angular position of a magnetron in the process chamber relative to a reference location on a surface of the substrate using positional information of a motor used to position the magnetron; and generate an arcing profile including a plurality of arcing states measured based at least on the determined angular position of the magnetron.

(8) Further embodiments of the disclosure are directed to a substrate processing system including: a process chamber having an inner volume; a substrate support disposed within the inner volume to support a substrate; a target having a front face exposed to the inner volume; a movable magnetron disposed proximate a back side of the target opposite the front face and rotatable about a central axis of the substrate support; and at least one power supply providing power to the process chamber; and a controller including a processor and a memory coupled to the processor, the memory having stored therein instructions executable by the processor to configure the controller to: determine at least an angular position of a magnetron in the process chamber relative to a reference location on a surface of the substrate using positional information of a motor used to position the magnetron; and generate an arcing profile including a plurality of arcing states measured based at least on the determined angular position of the magnetron.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) So that the manner in which the above recited features of the disclosure are attained and can be understood in detail, a more particular description of the disclosure, briefly summarized above, may be had by reference to the embodiments thereof which are illustrated in the appended drawings. It is to be noted, however, that the appended drawings illustrate only typical embodiments of this disclosure and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, for the disclosure may admit to other equally effective embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic cross-sectional view of a physical vapor deposition (PVD) chamber in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a high level block diagram of a system for controlling process uniformity on a

substrate within a process chamber in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a high level block diagram of a controller suitable for use in the system of FIG. 2 in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates a graphical representation of a method of monitoring arcing in a processing chamber including positional coordinates and arcing states;

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates a schematic representation of a substrate with the locations of the arcing states based on the graphical representation of the method of FIG. 4;

(7) FIG. 6A illustrates a 2D contour plot of the target voltage measurement from a VI sensor as a function of the X and Y position of the magnetron according to one or more embodiments of the disclosure;

(8) FIG. 6B illustrates a 2D contour plot of the wafer bias as might be measured from a wafer chucking power supply as a function of the X and Y position of the magnetron according to one or more embodiments of the disclosure; and

(9) FIGS. 6C and 6D illustrate 2D contour plots of the real (R) and imaginary (X) components, respectively, of the radio frequency (RF) impedance a match circuit between the power supply and the plasma as a function of the X and Y position of the magnetron according to one or more embodiments of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Before describing several exemplary embodiments of the disclosure, it is to be understood that the disclosure is not limited to the details of construction or process steps set forth in the following description. The disclosure is capable of other embodiments and of being practiced or being carried out in various ways.

(11) As used in this specification and the appended claims, the term “substrate” or “wafer” refers to a surface, or portion of a surface, upon which a process acts. It will also be understood by those skilled in the art that reference to a substrate can also refer to only a portion of the substrate, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. Additionally, reference to depositing on a substrate can mean both a bare substrate and a substrate with one or more films or features deposited or formed thereon.

(12) A “substrate” as used herein, refers to any substrate or material surface formed on a substrate upon which film processing is performed during a fabrication process. For example, a substrate surface on which processing can be performed include materials such as silicon, silicon oxide, strained silicon, silicon on insulator (SOI), carbon doped silicon oxides, amorphous silicon, doped silicon, germanium, gallium arsenide, glass, sapphire, and any other materials such as metals, metal nitrides, metal alloys, and other conductive materials, depending on the application. Substrates include, without limitation, semiconductor wafers. Substrates may be exposed to a pretreatment process to polish, etch, reduce, oxidize, hydroxylate, anneal, UV cure, e-beam cure and/or bake the substrate surface. In addition to film processing directly on the surface of the substrate itself, in the present disclosure, any of the film processing steps disclosed may also be performed on an underlayer formed on the substrate as disclosed in more detail below, and the term “substrate surface” is intended to include such underlayer as the context indicates. Thus, for example, where a film/layer or partial film/layer has been deposited onto a substrate surface, the exposed surface of the newly deposited film/layer becomes the substrate surface.

(13) As used in this specification and the appended claims, the terms “reactive compound”, “reactive gas”, “reactive species”, “precursor”, “process gas” and the like are used interchangeably to mean a substance with a species capable of reacting with the substrate surface or material on the substrate surface in a surface reaction (e.g., chemisorption, oxidation, reduction, cycloaddition). The substrate, or portion of the substrate, is exposed sequentially to the two or more reactive compounds which are introduced into a reaction zone of a processing chamber.

(14) The term “about” as used herein means approximately or nearly and in the context of a numerical value or range set forth means a variation of $\pm 15\%$ or less, of the numerical value. For

example, a value differing by $\pm 14\%$, $\pm 10\%$, $\pm 5\%$, $\pm 2\%$, $\pm 1\%$, $\pm 0.5\%$, or $\pm 0.1\%$ would satisfy the definition of “about.”

(15) Spatially relative terms, such as “beneath,” “below,” “lower,” “above,” “upper” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the Figures. It will be understood that the spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of a device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. For example, if the device in the Figures is turned over, elements described as “below” or “beneath” other elements or features would then be oriented “above” the other elements or features. Thus, the exemplary term “below” may encompass both an orientation of above and below. The device may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein interpreted accordingly.

(16) The use of the terms “a” and “an” and “the” and similar referents in the context of describing the materials and methods discussed herein (especially in the context of the following claims) are to be construed to cover both the singular and the plural, unless otherwise indicated herein or clearly contradicted by context. Recitation of ranges of values herein are merely intended to serve as a shorthand method of referring individually to each separate value falling within the range, unless otherwise indicated herein, and each separate value is incorporated into the specification as if it were individually recited herein. All methods described herein can be performed in any suitable order unless otherwise indicated herein or otherwise clearly contradicted by context. The use of any and all examples, or exemplary language (e.g., “such as”) provided herein, is intended merely to better illuminate the materials and methods and does not pose a limitation on the scope unless otherwise claimed. No language in the specification should be construed as indicating any non-claimed element as essential to the practice of the disclosed materials and methods.

(17) One or more embodiments of the disclosure relate to a high resolution control system that enables process monitoring based on an angular and/or a radial position of a magnetron in real time. For example, the magnetron position and/or angle and/or the radial position of the magnet may be used as a parameter in monitoring plasma arcing which can damage a wafer during processing, adding a new diagnostic and monitoring ability to a process chamber.

(18) Some embodiments of the disclosure advantageously allow for the plasma monitoring of a process chamber to determine arc occurrences. Some embodiments allow for the positional determination of arcing for diagnostics and repairs. In some embodiments, the arc state of a plasma is monitored at a time scale sufficiently low to allow for real-time monitoring. In some embodiments, the plasma monitoring of the process chamber allows for monitoring other sensor readings dynamically, including, but not limited to, target voltages, target current, collimator current, wafer bias, etc. In some embodiments, the sensor readings can be synchronized with the magnetron position (plasma location) and diagnose potential geometrical abnormalities of the plasma.

(19) FIG. 1 depicts an illustrative PVD chamber (process chamber **100**), e.g., a sputter process chamber, suitable for sputter depositing materials on a substrate in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. The skilled artisan will recognize that other process chambers that use a magnetron can also be employed and that the disclosure is not limited to PVD chambers.

(20) The process chamber **100** has an upper sidewall **102**, a lower sidewall **103**, a ground adapter **104**, and a lid assembly **111** defining a body **105** that encloses an interior volume **106** thereof. An adapter plate **107** may be disposed between the upper sidewall **102** and the lower sidewall **103**. A substrate support, such as a pedestal **108**, is disposed in the interior volume **106** of the process chamber **100**. A substrate transfer port **109** is formed in the lower sidewall **103** for transferring substrates into and out of the interior volume **106**.

(21) In some embodiments, the process chamber **100** is configured to deposit, for example, titanium, aluminum oxide, aluminum, aluminum oxynitride, copper, tantalum, tantalum nitride, tantalum oxynitride, titanium oxynitride, tungsten, tungsten nitride, or other materials, on a

substrate, such as the substrate **101**.

(22) A gas source **110** is coupled to the process chamber **100** to supply process gases into the interior volume **106**. In some embodiments, process gases may include inert gases, non-reactive gases, and reactive gases, if necessary. Examples of process gases that may be provided by the gas source **110** include, but not limited to, argon gas (Ar), helium (He), neon gas (Ne), nitrogen gas (N₂), oxygen gas (O₂), and water (H₂O) vapor among others.

(23) A pump **112** is coupled to the process chamber **100** in communication with the interior volume **106** to control the pressure of the interior volume **106** to any suitable pressure for a given process. In some embodiments, during deposition the pressure level of the process chamber **100** may be maintained at about 1 Torr or less. In some embodiments, the pressure level of the process chamber **100** may be maintained at about 500 mTorr or less during deposition. In some embodiments, the pressure level of the process chamber **100** may be maintained at about 1 mTorr and about 300 mTorr during deposition.

(24) The ground adapter **104** may support a target **114** (also referred to as a sputtering source). The target **114** has a front surface **114f** exposed to the interior volume **106**. The target **114** comprises a suitable material to be sputter deposited on a substrate. In some embodiments, the target **114** may be fabricated from titanium (Ti) metal, tantalum metal (Ta), tungsten (W) metal, cobalt (Co), nickel (Ni), copper (Cu), aluminum (Al), alloys thereof, combinations thereof, or the like.

(25) The target **114** may be coupled to a source assembly **116** comprising a power supply **117** for the target **114**. In some embodiments, the power supply **117** may be an RF power supply. In some embodiments, the power supply **117** may alternatively be a DC power supply. In some embodiments, the power supply **117** may include both DC and RF power sources.

(26) A magnetron assembly (magnetron **119**) which includes set of rotatable magnets may be coupled adjacent to the target **114** which enhances efficient sputtering materials from the target **114** during processing. The magnetron **119** is also referred to as a movable magnetron and is disposed proximate the back surface **114b** of the target **114**, opposite the front surface **114f** of the target **114**. Examples of the magnetron assembly include an electromagnetic linear magnetron, a serpentine magnetron, a spiral magnetron, a double-digitated magnetron, a rectangularized spiral magnetron, among others. The magnetron assembly includes at least one motor for controlling the rotation of the magnets. In some embodiments, two motors are provided for controlling the rotation of the magnets. Rotary encoders, position sensors, or the like may be used to provide a signal representative of the angular position of the magnetron **119**. The radial position of the magnetron **119** may be calculated from the angular position or may be determined using one or more encoders, position sensors, or the like.

(27) In some embodiments, a first set of magnets **194** may be disposed between the adapter plate **107** and the upper sidewall **102** to assist generating a magnetic field to guide the metallic ions dislodged from the target **114**. A second set of magnets **196** may be disposed adjacent to the ground adapter **104** to assist generating the magnetic field to guide dislodged materials from the target **114**. The numbers of the magnets disposed around the process chamber **100** may be selected to control plasma dissociation and sputtering efficiency. The first and second sets of magnets **194**, **196** may be electromagnets coupled to a power source for controlling the magnitude of the magnetic field generated by the electromagnets.

(28) An RF power source **180** may be coupled to the process chamber **100** through the pedestal **108** to provide a bias power between the target **114** and the pedestal **108**. In some embodiments, the RF power source **180** may have a frequency between about 400 Hz and about 60 MHz, such as about 13.56 MHz.

(29) The process chamber **100** further includes an upper shield **113** and a lower shield **120**. A collimator **118** is positioned in the interior volume **106** between the target **114** and the pedestal **108**. The collimator **118** includes a plurality of apertures to direct gas and/or material flux within the interior volume **106**. The collimator **118** is coupled to the upper shield **113** using any fixation

means. In some embodiments, the collimator **118** may be formed integrally with the upper shield **113**. The collimator **118** may be electrically biased to control ion flux to the substrate and neutral angular distribution at the substrate, as well as to increase the deposition rate due to the added DC bias. Electrically biasing the collimator results in reduced ion loss to the collimator to advantageously enable greater ion/neutral ratios at the substrate. Optionally, a switch **199** may be disposed between the upper shield **113** and the collimator power source **190** to selectively couple the upper shield **113** and collimator **118** to the collimator power source **190**.

(30) In some embodiments, the collimator **118** may be electrically biased in bipolar mode so as to control the direction of the ions passing through the collimator **118**. For example, a controllable direct current (DC) or AC collimator power source **190** may be coupled to the collimator **118** to provide an alternating pulsed positive or negative voltage to the collimator **118** so as to bias the collimator **118**. In some embodiments, the collimator power source **190** is a DC power source.

(31) To facilitate applying bias to the collimator **118**, the collimator **118** is electrically isolated from grounded chamber components such as the ground adapter **104**. For example, in the embodiment depicted in FIG. **1**, the collimator **118** is coupled to the upper shield **113**, which in turn is coupled to the process tool adapter **138**. The process tool adapter **138** may be made from suitable conductive materials compatible with processing conditions in the process chamber **100**. An insulator ring **156** and an insulator ring **157** are disposed on either side of the process tool adapter **138** to electrically isolate the process tool adapter **138** from the ground adapter **104**. The insulator rings **156**, **157** may be made from suitable process compatible dielectric materials.

(32) The process tool adapter **138** includes one or more features to facilitate supporting a process tool within the interior volume **106**, such as the collimator **118**. For example, as shown in FIG. **1**, the process tool adapter **138** includes a mounting ring, or shelf **164** that extends in a radially inward direction to support the upper shield **113**. In some embodiments, the mounting ring or shelf **164** is a continuous ring about the inner diameter of the process tool adapter **138** to facilitate more uniform thermal contact with the upper shield **113** mounted to the process tool adapter **138**.

(33) In some embodiments, a coolant channel **166** may be provided in the process tool adapter **138** to facilitate flowing a coolant through the process tool adapter **138** to remove heat generated during processing. For example, the coolant channel **166** may be coupled to a coolant source **153** to provide a suitable coolant, such as water. The coolant channel **166** advantageously removes heat from the process tool (e.g., collimator **118**) that is not readily transferred to other cooled chamber components, such as the ground adapter **104**. For example, the insulator rings **156**, **157** disposed between the process tool adapter **138** and the ground adapter **104** are typically made from materials with poor thermal conductivity. Thus, the insulator rings **156**, **157** reduce the rate of heat transfer from the collimator **118** to the ground adapter **104** and the process tool adapter **138** advantageously maintains or increases the rate of cooling of the collimator **118**. In addition to the coolant channel **166** provided in the process tool adapter **138**, the ground adapter **104** may also include a coolant channel to further facilitate removing heat generated during processing.

(34) A radially inwardly extending ledge (e.g., the mounting ring, or shelf **164**) is provided to support the upper shield **113** within the central opening within the interior volume **106** of the process chamber **100**. In some embodiments the shelf **164** is disposed in a location proximate the coolant channel **166** to facilitate maximizing the heat transfer from the collimator **118** to the coolant flowing in the coolant channel **166** during use.

(35) In some embodiments, the lower shield **120** may be provided in proximity to the collimator **118** and interior of the ground adapter **104** or the upper sidewall **102**. The lower shield **120** may include a tubular body **121** having a radially outwardly extending flange **122** disposed in an upper surface of the tubular body **121**. The flange **122** provides a mating interface with an upper surface of the upper sidewall **102**. In some embodiments, the tubular body **121** of the lower shield **120** may include a shoulder region **123** having an inner diameter that is less than the inner diameter of the remainder of the tubular body **121**. In some embodiments, the inner surface of the tubular body **121**

transitions radially inward along a tapered surface **124** to an inner surface of the shoulder region **123**.

(36) A shield ring **126** may be disposed in the process chamber **100** adjacent to the lower shield **120** and intermediate of the lower shield **120** and the adapter plate **107**. The shield ring **126** may be at least partially disposed in a recess **128** formed by an opposing side of the shoulder region **123** of the lower shield **120** and an interior sidewall of the adapter plate **107**.

(37) In some embodiments, the shield ring **126** may include an axially projecting annular sidewall **127** that has an inner diameter that is greater than an outer diameter of the shoulder region **123** of the lower shield **120**. A radial flange **130** extends from the annular sidewall **127**. The radial flange **130** includes a protrusion **132** formed on a lower surface of the radial flange **130**. The protrusion **132** may be a circular ridge extending from the surface of the radial flange **130** in an orientation that is substantially parallel to the inside diameter surface of the annular sidewall **127** of the shield ring **126**. The protrusion **132** is generally adapted to mate with a recess **134** formed in an edge ring **136** disposed on the pedestal **108**. The recess **134** may be a circular groove formed in the edge ring **136**. The engagement of the protrusion **132** and the recess **134** centers the shield ring **126** with respect to the longitudinal axis of the pedestal **108**.

(38) The substrate **101** (shown supported on lift pins **140**) is centered relative to the longitudinal axis of the pedestal **108** by coordinated positioning calibration between the pedestal **108** and a robot blade (not shown). Thus, the substrate **101** may be centered within the process chamber **100** and the shield ring **126** may be centered radially about the substrate **101** during processing.

(39) In operation, a robot blade (not shown) having the substrate **101** (also referred to as a wafer) disposed thereon is extended through the substrate transfer port **109**. The pedestal **108** may be lowered to allow the substrate **101** to be transferred to the lift pins **140** extending from the pedestal **108**. Lifting and lowering of the pedestal **108** and/or the lift pins **140** may be controlled by a drive **142** coupled to the pedestal **108**. The substrate **101** may be lowered onto a substrate receiving surface **144** of the pedestal **108**. With the substrate **101** positioned on the substrate receiving surface **144** of the pedestal **108**, sputter deposition may be performed on the substrate **101**. The edge ring **136** may be electrically insulated from the substrate **101** during processing. Therefore, the substrate receiving surface **144** may have a height that is greater than a height of portions of the edge ring **136** adjacent the substrate **101** such that the substrate **101** is prevented from contacting the edge ring **136**. During sputter deposition, the temperature of the substrate **101** may be controlled by utilizing thermal control channels **146** disposed in the pedestal **108**.

(40) In some processes, after sputter deposition, the substrate **101** may be elevated utilizing the lift pins **140** to a position that is spaced away from the pedestal **108**. The elevated location may be proximate one or both of the shield ring **126** and a reflector ring **148** adjacent to the adapter plate **107**. The adapter plate **107** includes one or more lamps **150** coupled to the adapter plate **107** at a position intermediate of a lower surface of the reflector ring **148** and a concave surface **152** of the adapter plate **107**. The lamps **150** provide optical and/or radiant energy in the visible or near visible wavelengths, such as in the infra-red (IR) and/or ultraviolet (UV) spectrum. The energy from the lamps **150** is focused radially inward toward the backside (i.e., lower surface) of the substrate **101** to heat the substrate **101** and the material deposited thereon. In some embodiments, reflective surfaces on the chamber components surrounding the substrate **101** serve to focus the energy towards the backside of the substrate **101** and away from other chamber components where the energy would be lost and/or not utilized. The adapter plate **107** may be coupled to the coolant source **153** or **154** to control the temperature of the adapter plate **107** during heating.

(41) After controlling the substrate **101** to a predetermined temperature, the substrate **101** is lowered to a position on the substrate receiving surface **144** of the pedestal **108**. The substrate **101** may be rapidly cooled utilizing the thermal control channels **146** in the pedestal **108** via conduction. The temperature of the substrate **101** may be ramped down from the first temperature to a second temperature in a matter of seconds to about a minute. The substrate **101** may be

removed from the process chamber **100** through the substrate transfer port **109** for further processing. The substrate **101** may be maintained at a predetermined temperature range, such as less than 250 degrees Celsius.

(42) A controller **198** is coupled to the process chamber **100**. The controller **198** includes a central processing unit (CPU) **160**, a memory **158**, and support circuits **162**. The controller **198** is utilized to control the process sequence, regulating the gas flows from the gas source **110** into the process chamber **100** and controlling ion bombardment of the target **114**. The CPU **160** may be of any form of a general purpose computer processor that can be used in an industrial setting. The software routines can be stored in the memory **158**, such as random access memory, read only memory, floppy or hard disk drive, or other form of digital storage. The support circuits **162** are conventionally coupled to the CPU **160** and may comprise cache, clock circuits, input/output subsystems, power supplies, and the like. The software routines, when executed by the CPU **160**, transform the CPU into a specific purpose computer (controller) **198** that controls the process chamber **100** such that the processes, including the processes disclosed below, are performed in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. The software routines may also be stored and/or executed by a second controller (not shown) that is located remotely from the process chamber **100**.

(43) In some embodiments, the process chamber **100** is wired for 4 msec or less network latency for digital communications to facilitate control of the process in substantially real time. As used herein, “real time” means less than 50 msec, 40 msec, 30 msec, 20 msec, 10 msec, 5 msec, 2 msec, 1 msec or less.

(44) During processing, material is sputtered from the target **114** and deposited on the surface of the substrate **101**. The target **114** and the pedestal **108** are biased relative to each other by the power supply **117** or the RF power source **180** to maintain a plasma formed from the process gases supplied by the gas source **110**. The DC power applied to the collimator **118** also assists with constant or pulsed power, controlling ratio of the ions and neutrals passing through the collimator **118**, advantageously enhancing the trench sidewall and bottom fill-up capability. The ions from the plasma are accelerated toward and strike the target **114**, causing target material to be dislodged from the target **114**. The dislodged target material, and in some embodiments one or more elements from the process gases, forms a layer on the substrate **101**.

(45) In operation and with reference to FIG. **1**, the magnetron **119** is positioned behind the target **114** to enhance the dislodging of target material in an area of the target **114** proximate the magnetron **119**. The inventors determined that the positional information of the magnetron **119** may be used to control a deposition or etching process to, for example, correct for uniformity errors in accordance with the principles described herein.

(46) The process chamber **100** of FIG. **1** is an illustrative example of a process chamber and is not limiting of the scope of the disclosure. In some embodiments in accordance with the present principles, a process chamber can include only some of the components of the process chamber **100** of FIG. **1**. For example, in the process chamber **100** of FIG. **1**, the lamps **150**, the reflector rings **148** and the collimator **118** can be considered optional components for some processes performed in the process chamber **100** of FIG. **1** to which embodiments in accordance with the present principles may be applied. In addition, although the process chamber **100** of FIG. **1** is depicted as a PVD chamber to be used for a material deposition process, in some embodiments, the inventive processes described herein can be applied to a sputter etching process in which the substrate to be etched may be considered the ‘target’.

(47) FIG. **2** depicts a high level block diagram of a system **200** for controlling process uniformity on a substrate within, for example a physical vapor deposition (PVD) chamber or an etching chamber, in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure. The system **200** of FIG. **2** illustratively comprises a controller **202** and a process chamber, such as the PVD process chamber **100** of FIG. **1** or, alternatively, an etching chamber (not shown). In various embodiments in

accordance with the present principles, the controller **202** of FIG. **2** can comprise the controller **198** of FIG. **1** or, in alternate embodiments, the controller **202** can be a second controller as described above with reference to controller **198** of FIG. **1**. FIG. **2** further illustratively depicts a representation of the power supplies **204.sub.1-204_n**, collectively power supplies **204**, associated with the various components of the process chamber **100**. Such power supplies can include DC or RF source power supply (e.g., power supply **117**), RF bias power supply (e.g., RF power source **180**), AC or DC shield bias voltage supply (e.g., collimator power source **190**), electromagnetic coil current supply (e.g., current supplied to first and/or second magnets **194, 196**), or any other power supplies affecting substrate processing.

(48) The system **200** of FIG. **2** further illustratively includes a two-axis driver **206** for controlling respective motors **208, 209** used to position the magnetron **119** of the process chamber **100**. In FIG. **2**, the power supplies **204**, the two-axis driver **206** and the respective motors **208, 209** are depicted as components separate from the process chamber **100**, however, in alternate embodiments in accordance with the present principles, the power supplies **204**, the two-axis driver **206** and the respective motors **208, 209** may comprise integrated components of the process chamber **100**.

(49) FIG. **3** depicts a high level block diagram of a controller **202** suitable for use in the system **200** of FIG. **2** in accordance with an embodiment of the present principles. The controller **202** of FIG. **3** comprises a processor **310** as well as a memory **320** for storing power control function types, such as functional curves, control programs, buffer pools and the like. The processor **310** cooperates with support circuitry **330** such as power supplies, clock circuits, cache memory and the like as well as circuits that assist in executing the software routines/programs stored in the memory **320**. As such, some of the process steps discussed herein as software processes may be implemented within hardware, for example, as circuitry that cooperates with the processor **310** to perform various steps. The controller **202** also contains input-output circuitry **340** that forms an interface between the various functional elements communicating with the controller **202**. As depicted in the embodiment of FIG. **3**, the controller **202** can further include a display **350**. The display **350** of the controller **202** may be used to present to a user, functional curves to be applied to power supplies affecting the deposition process, results of a deposition process having a functional curve applied in accordance with the teachings herein and the like.

(50) Although the controller **202** of FIG. **3** is depicted as a general purpose computer, the controller **202** is programmed to perform various specialized control functions in accordance with the present principles and embodiments of the controller **202** can be implemented in hardware, for example, as an application specified integrated circuit (ASIC). As such, the process steps described herein are intended to be broadly interpreted as being equivalently performed by software, hardware, or a combination thereof.

(51) In various embodiments of the disclosure, a substrate is processed in a suitable process chamber (such as the PVD process chamber **100** of FIG. **1**). In some embodiments, the substrate is a dummy substrate used for diagnostic purposes. In some embodiments, the diagnostic is performed on a live substrate during production. The method of some embodiments comprises monitoring arcing in the process chamber. As the magnetron moves, the plasma follows the magnetron position. The plasma moves on the microsecond scale while the magnetron rotation is on the second scale. Due to the plasma transport time scope (from the top of the chamber to the wafer at the bottom of the chamber) being substantially smaller than the magnet rotation time scale, the plasma location can be considered to be the same as the magnetron location. Communication with the power supply can allow for the measurement of arcing in the millisecond time scale. This is substantially faster than the magnetron rotation so that the measurements of the location of the arcing or other abnormal electrical signal or sensor feedback is determined with a degree of accuracy and precision that has not been previously possible.

(52) In a broad aspect, the method of some embodiments allows for the monitoring of arcing within the process chamber due to a shorting of the energy pathlength from the target to a portion of the

chamber that is not the substrate or a short of energy pathlength from any components that are next to each other inside the chamber cavity including the substrate, deposition ring, cover ring, shields, collimator and so forth (although the sensor in the power supply is routed to the target, it can sense the abnormal electric signal from the entire plasma since the plasma is continuous). Accordingly, one or more embodiments of the disclosure are directed to a method of monitoring arcing in a process chamber in which the angular and/or radial position and arcing profile are collected and analyzed. Some embodiments of the disclosure allow for the determination of the arcing position without opening the process chamber, breaking vacuum. Some embodiments of the disclosure assist in chamber troubleshooting. For example, if a consistent arcing happens in the same location, the arcing location can be correlated with components inside or outside of the chamber, so that the root cause can be identified. Being able to determine the root cause without opening the chamber to atmosphere can result in a substantial reduction in chamber down-time, ultimately decreasing the cost-of-ownership by keeping the chamber in service.

(53) In some embodiments, the controller **202** determines positions of the magnetron **119** relative to reference locations on a surface of a substrate to be processed. In some embodiments, the position of the magnetron **119** relative to a surface of a substrate may be determined by the controller **202** using motor encoder information provided to the controller **202** by the two-axis driver **206**. In some embodiments, home flags may establish a zero angular position for the magnetron with respect to a surface of a substrate being processed and may detect that angular position when the magnet passes the home flag sensor (e.g., once per revolution). In one or more embodiments, information regarding positions of the magnetron relative to reference locations on the surface of a substrate may be retrieved from a memory **320** of the controller **202**, having been previously determined and stored in the memory **320** of the controller **202**.

(54) FIG. 4 illustrates a graph of the position and arcing monitoring according to one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The angular position of a magnetron in the process chamber is determined relative to a reference location on the surface of the substrate using positional information of a motor used to position the magnetron. The graphic shows the X position and Y position as the magnetron moves. Arcing is measured within the chamber and correlated to the X and Y positions. For example, in some embodiments, a table of positional data and arcing states is collected which can then be analyzed to generate an arcing profile.

(55) The arcing profile provides the arcing state measured based at least on the determined angular position of the magnetron. In some embodiments, the plurality of arcing states comprises a NO ARC state, a MICRO ARC state and a HARD ARC state. The NO ARC state is indicated by a baseline measurement from a sensor configured to measure the existence of an arc discharge. For example, a V-I sensor in the plasma power source, or adjacent to and in electrical communication with the power source. When arcing occurs, the V-I sensor would measure a change in the power, current or voltage provided to generate the plasma relative to a baseline measurement. Electrical changes that can be monitored to indicate a change in the plasma provided to generate the plasma include, but are not limited to, a change in the electrical resistance, current, voltage, impedance, etc.

(56) The MICRO ARC state is indicated by a change in the power provided to the plasma that is below a predetermined arc threshold value. Micro-arcs can occur as the magnetron moves for any number of reasons. Micro-arcs are of sufficiently small magnitude so that damage to the chamber or substrate is within an acceptable level. The HARD ARC state is indicated by a change in the power or current provided to the plasma that is above a predetermined threshold value. Hard arcs are of sufficient magnitude so as to present a potential hazard to the process chamber of the substrate. The predetermined threshold value can be the upper bound of the MICRO ARC state, or can be the lower bound of the HARD ARC state. The graphic illustrated in FIG. 4 shows the Arc Threshold with four instances of MICRO ARCS and one instance of a HARD ARC.

(57) FIG. 5 shows an arcing map of a substrate or process chamber based on the arcing profile

collected during the method. The embodiment illustrated in FIG. 5 is indicative of the data that may be collected in a process similar to that illustrated in FIG. 4. The arcing map shows the location of the four MICRO ARC states and the one HARD ARC state as positions on the substrate or target within the chamber. In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 5, all of the arc states are measured at the same radial distance for the magnetron. In some embodiments, the radial distance of the magnetron is variable, and the arcing (or other electrical abnormalities) are measured at the relative radial locations.

(58) The number of measurements can be controlled to provide sufficient angular and arcing resolution to measure monitor the process chamber. In some embodiments, measurement of the arcing state occurs less than every 10 milliseconds, 5 milliseconds, 2 milliseconds, 1 millisecond or 0.5 milliseconds.

(59) In some embodiments, the method further comprises stopping the process occurring in the process chamber if a predetermined event occurs. In some embodiments, the process chamber is stopped if a HARD ARC has an arc magnitude that is above a predetermined arc magnitude stop threshold. In some embodiments, the process chamber is stopped if the number of HARD ARC states measured exceeds a predetermined numerical stop threshold.

(60) While the previous embodiments have been described with respect to plasma arcing, the skilled artisan will recognize that other electrical parameters and abnormalities can be monitored. For example, other electrical signal changes as a function of the magnetron position can capture the abnormality of the plasma at specific locations. Suitable sensor readings include, but are not limited to, readings for wafer potential (e.g., from a sensor in electrostatic chuck power supply), impedance (e.g., from a sensor in the RF match circuit), collimator current or power (e.g., from a sensor in the collimator power supply output voltage control). FIGS. 6A through 6D illustrate non-limiting examples of electrical parameters that can be monitored. FIG. 6A illustrates a 2D contour plot of the target voltage measurement from a VI sensor as a function of the X and Y position of the magnetron (shown as the dark path spiraling inward). FIG. 6B illustrates a 2D contour plot of the wafer bias as might be measured from a wafer chucking power supply as a function of the X and Y position of the magnetron. FIGS. 6C and 6D illustrate 2D contour plots of the real (R) and imaginary (X) components, respectively, of the RF impedance a match circuit between the power supply and the plasma as a function of the X and Y position of the magnetron. Additional embodiments of the disclosure are directed to apparatus for monitoring arcing within a process chamber including a moveable magnetron and at least one power supply. The apparatus of some embodiments comprises a process and a memory coupled thereto that has executable instructions to configure the apparatus to perform the monitoring process as described herein. Further embodiments of the disclosure are directed to substrate processing systems comprising a processing chamber as described herein with a substrate support, target, a movable magnetron, at least one power supply and a controller. The controller, as described herein, includes instructions to perform the monitoring process as described herein.

(61) Although the disclosure herein has been described with reference to particular embodiments, it is to be understood that these embodiments are merely illustrative of the principles and applications of the present disclosure. It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the method and apparatus of the present disclosure without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. Thus, it is intended that the present disclosure includes modifications and variations that are within the scope of the appended claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A method of monitoring arcing in a process chamber, the method comprising: determining at least an angular position of a magnetron in the process chamber relative to a reference location on a surface of a substrate using positional information of a motor used to position the magnetron; and

generating an arcing profile comprising a plurality of arcing states measured based at least on the determined angular position of the magnetron.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of arcing states comprises a NO ARC state in which there is no arcing measured, a MICRO ARC state in which an arc magnitude is measured below a predetermined arc threshold, and a HARD ARC state in which an arc magnitude is measured greater than the predetermined arc threshold.

3. The method of claim 2, further comprising stopping the method if a HARD ARC has an arc magnitude above a predetermined arc magnitude threshold, or a number of HARD ARCs exceeds a predetermined stop threshold.

4. The method of claim 2, wherein measuring the plurality of arcing states comprises a V-I sensor operating at a frequency less than 50 msec.

5. The method of claim 2, further comprising generating an arcing map based on the arcing profile, the arcing map indicating locations of MICRO ARC states and HARD ARC states relative to the determined angular position of the magnetron.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein determining at least the angular position comprises determining an angular position of the magnetron relative to a central axis of or the reference location on the surface of the substrate.

7. An apparatus for monitoring arcing within a process chamber including a moveable magnetron and at least one power supply, the apparatus comprising: a processor; and a memory coupled to the processor, the memory having stored therein instructions executable by the processor to configure the apparatus to: determine at least an angular position of a magnetron in the process chamber relative to a reference location on a surface of a substrate using positional information of a motor used to position the magnetron; and generate an arcing profile comprising a plurality of arcing states measured based at least on the determined angular position of the magnetron.

8. The apparatus of claim 7, wherein the at least one power supply comprises a direct current (DC) source, a radio frequency (RF) source.

9. The apparatus of claim 8, wherein the plurality of arcing states comprises a NO ARC state in which there is no arcing measured, a MICRO ARC state in which an arc magnitude is measured below a predetermined arc threshold, and a HARD ARC state in which an arc magnitude is measured greater than the predetermined arc threshold.

10. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the processor is further configured to stop the apparatus if a HARD ARC has an arc magnitude above a predetermined arc magnitude threshold, or a number of HARD ARCs exceeds a predetermined stop threshold.

11. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein measuring the plurality of arcing states comprises a V-I sensor operating at a frequency less than 50 msec.

12. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the V-I sensor is within the at least one power supply.

13. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the processor is further configured to generate an arcing map based on the arcing profile, the arcing map indicating locations of MICRO ARC states and HARD ARC states relative to the determined angular position of the magnetron.

14. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the angular position of the magnetron is determined relative to the reference location on the surface of the substrate using a motor encoder information provided to the processor by a two-axis driver.

15. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the process chamber comprises a two-axis driver for controlling a movement of the magnetron and communicating position information of the magnetron to the apparatus, and the apparatus generates the arcing profile comprising the plurality of arcing states as a function of the position information of the magnetron.

16. A substrate processing system comprising: a process chamber, comprising; an inner volume; a substrate support disposed within the inner volume to support a substrate; a movable magnetron configured to be disposed proximate a back side of a target opposite a front face of the target and rotatable about a central axis of the substrate support; and at least one power supply providing

power to the process chamber; and a controller comprising a processor and a memory coupled to the processor, the memory having stored therein instructions executable by the processor to configure the controller to: determine at least an angular position of the movable magnetron in the process chamber relative to a reference location on a surface of the substrate using positional information of a motor used to position the magnetron; and generate an arcing profile comprising a plurality of arcing states measured based at least on the determined angular position of the magnetron.

17. The substrate processing system of claim 16, wherein the plurality of arcing states comprises a NO ARC state in which there is no arcing measured, a MICRO ARC state in which an arc magnitude is measured below a predetermined arc threshold, and a HARD ARC state in which an arc magnitude is measured greater than the predetermined arc threshold.

18. The substrate processing system of claim 17, wherein the controller is further configured to stop the substrate processing system if a HARD ARC has an arc magnitude above a predetermined arc magnitude threshold, or a number of HARD ARCs exceeds a predetermined stop threshold.

19. The substrate processing system of claim 17, wherein measuring the plurality of arcing states comprises a V-I sensor operating at a frequency less than 10 msec.

20. The substrate processing system of claim 17, further comprising generating an arcing map based on the arcing profile, the arcing map indicating a location of MICRO ARC states and HARD ARC states relative to the determined angular position of the magnetron.
